Walt

Europe reclaims tap-to-pay

The Problem

Tap-to-pay in Europe lives with Google and Apple

200–250M

Europeans use Apple Pay or Google Wallet for in-store purchases[1]

€700B+

in mobile wallet payments at European point-of-sale terminals (2024)[2]

<0.4% combined market share for everyone else.[3] No legitimate tap-to-pay alternative exists for either iPhone or Android.

Apple Pay

- Charges European banks ~0.05% per transaction [4]
- Extracts €300–500M annually from European transactions [5]

Google Wallet

- Harvests every transaction for ad profiles and selling to 3rd parties [6]
- Estimated €1B+ annually in ad value from European payment data [7] [8]

The only alternative is to go back to physical cards or cash. For Europeans who care about privacy, there is no tap-to-pay option at all.

Solution

A European, privacy-first alternative to Apple Pay and Google Wallet

Privacy by design

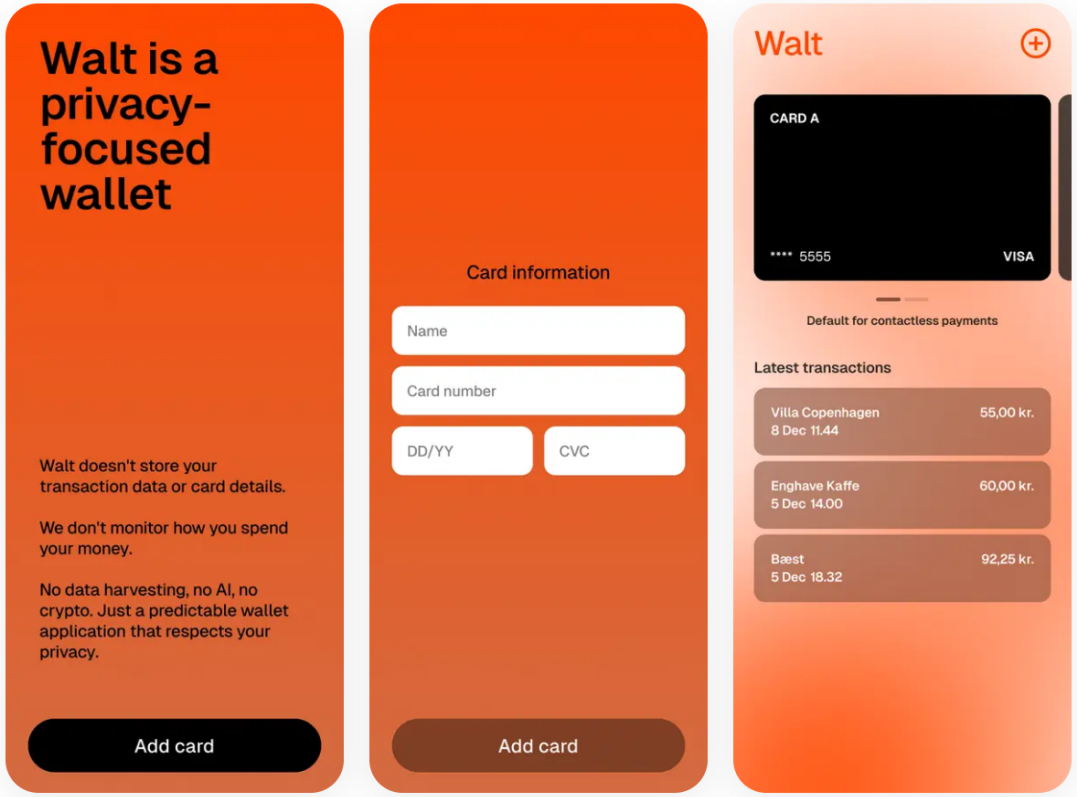
- Transaction data stays on the device. No centralized database, no server-side logs
- No ad profiling, no data harvesting, no third-party sharing

Built for Europe

- Founded in Copenhagen to establish European sovereignty
- No dependency on US cloud providers for core infrastructure

Simplicity

- Entire app is tap-to-pay. One workflow, nothing else
- One pricing model, no tiers, no extra features to upsell



Download | Add card | Tap to pay

Why Now?

EU regulation opens tap-to-pay to third-party wallets

2014–2024

iPhone NFC locked

Apple restricts iPhone NFC exclusively to Apple Pay. No third-party wallet can offer tap-to-pay on iPhone for a decade[9]

2024

EUDI wallet mandate

EU regulation mandates privacy-by-design digital wallets across all 27 member states[10]

DEC 2024

First alternative launches

Vipps MobilePay goes live as the first Apple Pay alternative on iPhone. 200K cards activated in 24 hours[11]

JAN 2025

First NFC transaction

First third-party contactless payment completed on iPhone via the new NFC APIs[12]

MAR 2025

Walt

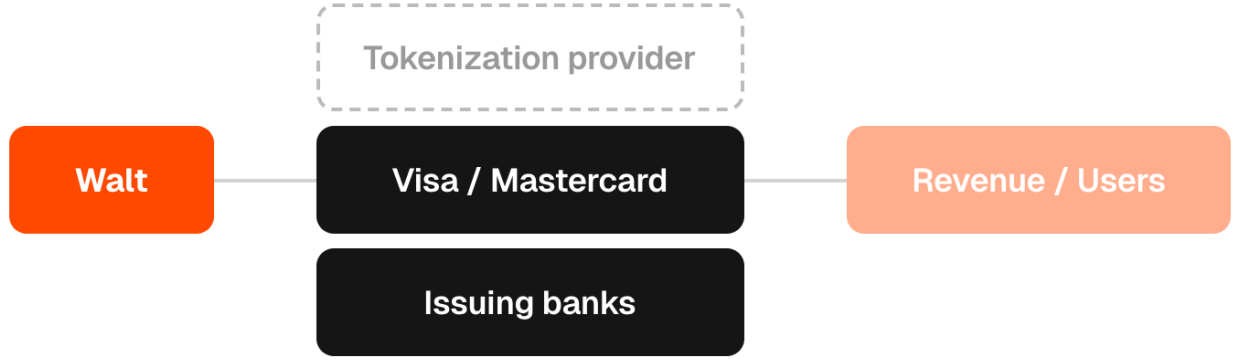
The first entirely private tap-to-pay wallet enters the market

For the first time, a completely private tap-to-pay wallet is possible on every smartphone in Europe.

Product Deep-Dive

Challenges

The infrastructure for third-party phone wallets is still being built



To enable tap-to-pay, Walt needs a **tokenization provider**: a company certified by Visa and Mastercard that converts card numbers into secure payment tokens, connecting a wallet to the banking system. The EU opened iPhone NFC to third parties in 2024, but no provider yet offers a production-ready SDK for independent phone wallets.

IDEMIA

FULL SDK, ENTERPRISE ONLY

World's largest independent token service provider. Launched Tap & Pay SDKs for both iOS and Android.

Will not engage with early-stage startups.

Fidesmo

860+ BANKS, NO PHONE SDK

Certified Token Requestor for Visa and Mastercard with pre-approved issuers across Europe, including key Nordic banks.

Wearables only.

Paymentology

HCE SDK, NOT PRODUCTION-READY

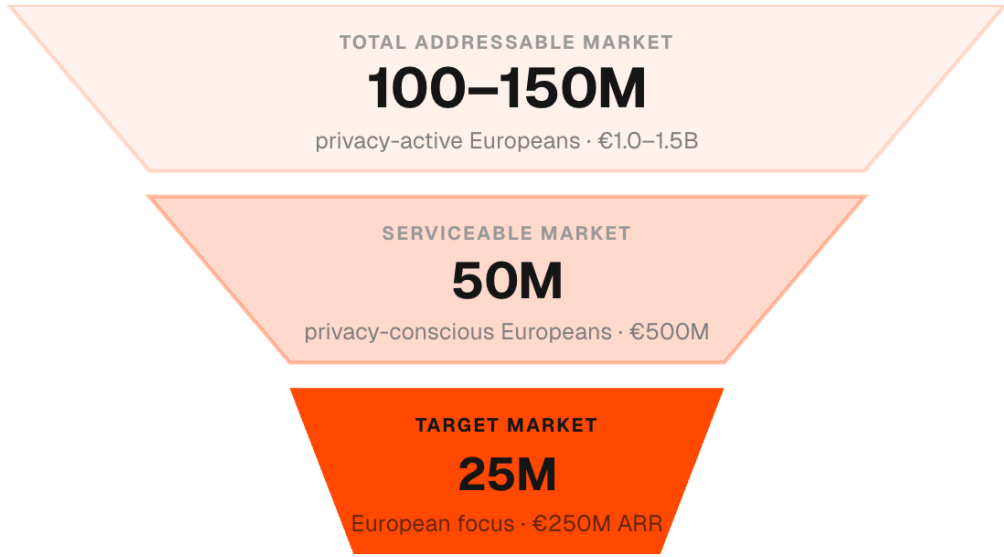
Global card issuing processor. Subsidiary MeaWallet provides an HCE SDK and tokenization infrastructure.

Phone wallet SDK not yet production-ready for third-party tap-to-pay.

The Market

Privacy is a proven, paying market

MARKET SIZING AT €10/YEAR



PROVEN DEMAND

3 privacy companies have crossed $100M in annual revenue[14]

COMPANY	SCALE	REVENUE
Proton	100M+ accounts	~$97.5M
Brave	101M MAU	$100M+
DuckDuckGo	100M daily searches	$100M+
Signal	70M+ MAU	~$25.8M

Competitors

Competitors offering tap-to-pay as a secondary feature

	Walt	Wero	Vipps
NFC tap-to-pay is core product	✓	—	—
NFC tap-to-pay live today	—	—	✓ Limited
Private, no data collection	✓	—	—
User base	**0**	50M	12.5M
Revenue model	**€10/yr subscription**	Merchant pays fee	Merchant pays fee
Geographic focus	**Europe**	DE, FR, BE	Nordics

Traction & Roadmap

Pre-launch with core infrastructure in place

CURRENT STATUS

3k signups

Pre-launch · 3+ months from first transaction

MILESTONES

- ✓ Android and iPhone apps built
- ✓ End-to-end PCI compliance
- ✓ Organic customer validation (r/BuyFromEU)
- ○ Tokenization provider partnership
- ○ First cards loaded
- ○ First tap-to-pay transaction

GO-TO-MARKET

PHASE 1 **Privacy communities**

Target: Early adopters & beta

Organic word-of-mouth in privacy-focused communities. Early adopters sign up for the beta program.

PHASE 2 **Organic European growth**

Target: Niche communities

Expand across Europe through organic discovery in communities like Reddit, Mastodon, and privacy forums.

PHASE 3 **High-visibility channels**

Target: Scaled distribution

Targeted reach across privacy-aligned platforms: Proton, Brave, DuckDuckGo, and similar channels.

TARGET MARKET	SERVICEABLE MARKET	TOTAL ADDRESSABLE
25M	50M	100–150M
€250M ARR	€500M	€1.0–1.5B

The Ask

Walt

Europe reclaims tap-to-pay

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References

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7. Alphabet 10-K (2024): EMEA revenue $102B; Proton data valuation methodology estimates €15–30 ad value per European wallet user per year
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